

Facilitator copy. Contains answer keys and grading guidance. Do not publish to students.



Optima Academy Online
An Education Experience Company

Teacher Manual

2D Studio Art 2 · CPALMS Course Code 0101310 · Grades 9–12 · Full-Year Studio Elective

Structure: 18 two-week decision-based Studios, 4 quarters (4 / 4 / 4 / 6 Studios)

Delivery: On-Demand (asynchronous) and Live (synchronous) sections, shared content

Manual date: July 15, 2026

How to use this manual

This is a standalone, teacher-only document. It is not part of the student-facing course and should never be linked, pasted, or exported into a student-visible Canvas page. It documents the course exactly as built in 04_Final (Semester 1: Studios 1–8; Semester 2: Studios 9–18) — every standard code, rubric row, artist, and copyright note below was read directly out of each Studio's teacher-cycle-plan.md and canvas-items.md, not assumed. Anything the build team flagged as needing confirmation is marked **[VERIFY]** — treat those as open items, not settled facts.

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SECTION 1

How this course works

A typical lesson — walked through top to bottom (Studio 1, Lesson 1, "Seeing vs. Looking")

Every Studio runs the same six-lesson arc: **1 Observe · 2 Investigate/critique · 3 Skill Builder A · 4 Skill Builder B · 5 Plan & Create (VR Session or Art Critique + AI) · 6 Refine, Reflect & Present**. A facilitator who has read one Studio's six lessons has read the shape of all eighteen.

Lesson	What it is	Graded touchpoint?
1 · Observe	Essential Question, Big Idea, Look First on the featured artwork (embedded if public domain, link-out card if in-copyright), one reflective check-in widget.	No
2 · Investigate	Artist study + a "What Works?" critique walkthrough of a featured work (Describe → Analyze → Interpret → Judge, taught as the critique process; the acronym is named only in the four quarter-opening Studios — see Section 12). One evaluative widget.	No
3 · Skill Builder A	Guided practice of the Studio's first core technique, a diagram visual, and a paired completion sketch (Canvas item, Skill Builder 1).	Indirect — the sketch itself is graded (Tier 1)
4 · Skill Builder B	Guided practice of the second core technique, a diagram visual, and a paired completion sketch (Skill Builder 2).	Indirect — Tier 1
5 · Plan & Create	Plans the Studio Project; the VR Session (Semester 1) or Art Critique (Semester 2); the factual AI-awareness callout; begins the graded artwork.	Links to the VR Session or Art Critique and the Studio Project below
6 · Refine, Reflect & Present	Refinement strategies, self-critique (always called "critique," never the acronym), artist-statement guidance, rubric preview, submission checklist.	Feeds the Studio Project submission

The six lesson pages are ungraded and GitHub-deployed, embedded in Canvas via iframe (see Section 2). Everything gradable is built Canvas-native, per each Studio's `canvas-items.md`.

A typical week

Every Studio is a two-week, ~250 min/week cycle. The shape is identical across all 18 Studios (per the July 2026 revision, the Quiz now sits in Week 2, not Week 1).

Segment	What the student does	Graded?	Tier
Studio opens	Intro survey (Essential Question first answer, goals acknowledgment) — solo, no partner/group option	Completion / survey	Tier 4
Week 1	Lessons 1–2 (Observe, Investigate) + Lessons 3–4 with Skill Builders 1 & 2 (guided practice sketches)	Skill Builders: completion, 10 pts each	Tier 1
Week 2	Lesson 5 (Plan & Create, AI awareness), the Quiz, the VR Session (S1) or Art Critique (S2), Lesson 6 (Refine/Reflect/Present)	Quiz auto-graded; VR Session / Art Critique completion	Tier 1
Week 2	Studio Project + Artist Statement (single submission)	Teacher rubric — the one teacher-graded event per cycle	Tier 3
Studio closes	Outro survey (growth reflection, preview of the next Studio)	Completion / survey	Tier 4

There is no discussion forum and no Tier 2 item anywhere in this course's built cycle — the per-cycle item set is exactly five things: two Skill Builders, one Quiz, one VR Session or Art Critique (all Tier 1), and one Studio Project + Artist Statement (Tier 3), bracketed by the Tier 4 intro/outro survey pair.

Major assessments — every Studio's Tier 3 item

Studio	Title	Studio Project	Grading time (per student, roughly)
1	Learning to See	The Extraordinary Ordinary	~5 min
2	Organizing the Image	Three Arrangements	~5–6 min
3	Color Speaks	Three Moods, One Subject	~5–6 min (three versions to compare)

4	Creating Space	Step Into This Place	~5 min
5	Pattern, Print & Design	Multiplied	~5 min
6	Layers of Meaning	Memory in Layers	~5 min
7	Identity	The Symbolic Self	~5 min
8	Mid-Year Portfolio Review	Mid-Year Portfolio + Reflective Artist Statement (4–6 pieces)	~5 min (reviewing an already-curated set)
9	Transformation	From Study to Stylization	~5 min
10	Visual Storytelling	A Visual Story	~5 min
11	Design for Communication	Poster With a Purpose	~5 min
12	Beyond Reality	An Idea Without a Subject	~5 min
13	Dream Worlds	Dream Worlds	~5 min
14	Art & Society	A Cause Worth Making	~5 min (responsible-commentary judgment)
15	Experimental Studio	Risk Log: A Series of Experimental Works (3+ pieces)	~5–7 min (series + log)
16	Independent Investigation	The Capstone Proposal (Word .docx)	~5 min (varies — every student researches a different artist)
17	Capstone Studio	The Capstone Artwork	~5–7 min (cross-reference the student's Studio 16 proposal)
18	Portfolio & Exhibition	Final Exhibition (6–10 curated works)	~5–7 min — the last teacher-graded item of the year

Grading-time estimates come directly from each Studio's teacher-cycle-plan; treat as a planning aid, not a guarantee.

DEPENDENCY FLAG

Studio 17 (Capstone Studio) assumes Studio 16 (Independent Investigation) is already complete and each student has an **approved** proposal on file. If a student's Studio 16 proposal isn't approved when Studio 17 opens, hold that student's Studio 17 start rather than let them begin without a plan.

SECTION 2

Ungraded interactives & the intro/outro wrappers

Ungraded interactive activities

Every lesson carries small self-check widgets (a reflective check-in on Lesson 1, an evaluative widget on Lesson 2, a diagram + check on Lessons 3–4). None of these produce a Canvas submission and none need grading — they are formation-by-practice. If a student skips them, it shows up indirectly in Skill Builder quality or the Studio Project, not as a missing grade.

In-copyright and living artists (e.g. Edward Hopper and Henri Cartier-Bresson in Studio 2; Henri Matisse and Mark Rothko in Studio 3; M. C. Escher in Studio 4; Andy Warhol and Elizabeth Catlett in Studio 5; Hannah Höch, Kurt Schwitters, and Romare Bearden in Studio 6 — all three of that Studio's artists; Frida Kahlo, Amy Sherald, and Kehinde Wiley in Studio 7, the latter two **living artists**; Salvador Dalí, René Magritte, and Remedios Varo in Studio 13; Barbara Kruger and Shepard Fairey in Studio 14, both **living**; Helen Frankenthaler and Wifredo Arcay in Studio 12; Jacob Lawrence and Norman Rockwell in Studio 10; Paula Scher and Saul Bass in Studio 11) are handled the same way every time: a described work plus a "View this work at [Museum]" link-out card, never an embedded image. Public-domain works (Leonardo, Hokusai, Van Gogh, Canaletto; O'Keeffe's 1924 painting and Kandinsky's 1921 painting under a US-publication-date PD claim) are embedded inline with attribution.

Intro/outro wrappers — Canvas Quizzes, not pages

Both wrappers are built Canvas-native (survey/completion, Tier 4), never as wiki pages and never custom-coded. Every Intro explicitly notes "**(solo; no partner or group option)**" — with one deliberate, owner-approved exception: Studio 14's Studio Project adds a Step 2b pairing students with a classmate who chose a related cause, to compare issue statements and decide whether their finished pieces hang as a connected pair or combine into one shared piece. Grading remains fully individual even there.

THE HIGHEST-LEVERAGE 15–20 MINUTES IN THE COURSE

After each Studio closes, spend 15–20 minutes triaging the outro survey before moving on. Look for a repeated "still unclear" phrase across several students, or

a cluster of low-confidence responses — that is the cheapest point to re-teach a concept, before the next Studio opens.

SECTION 3

AI & VR in this course (student-facing)

AI

Every Studio's Lesson 5 ("Plan & Create") carries a factual AI-awareness callout, consistent with Optima's standing policy: AI awareness, not required tool use; the callout states what AI can and cannot do for the task at hand and stops there, never persuasive, never naming a required AI product. Studio 16 (Independent Investigation) additionally ties AI-awareness to research: using AI to help search or summarize versus using it to make the art or write the proposal. Studio 14 (Art & Society) goes one step further and makes AI-disclosure part of the graded item itself: the Artist Statement must disclose any AI use at any stage of that Studio Project, and an undisclosed use scores at the lowest rubric level.

VR

Semester 1 (Studios 1–8): every Studio has a VR Session (Tier 1, completion, platform-agnostic; it works identically for a solo asynchronous student or a live class). Each session is paired with Lesson 5 and typically runs a short critique-in-VR segment, a brief reflection, and a hands-on VR making task (e.g., composing a still life three ways in Studio 2, repainting a gallery scene's palette in Studio 3, hanging a mid-year gallery in Studio 8). VR sessions default to **student choice of Location**; students may choose any gallery/space they like unless a specific snapshot is called for.

Semester 2 (Studios 9–18): the Week 2 item is an **Art Critique** (Tier 1, completion, 10 pts), which students may complete in VR or on screen. The student chooses one work and writes one or two sentences for each step: Describe, Analyze, Interpret, Judge. Studios 9–14 critique a Lesson 2 artwork; Studio 15 a rule-breaking artist; Studio 16 the student's researched artist; Studio 17 the student's Capstone in progress; Studio 18 one piece from the Final Exhibition. Submission is text entry or an upload (Word document or voice recording) and is the same whether or not the student used VR. The student-facing page does not explain VR access or how to handle the artwork in VR; give that support in class or office hours.

SECTION 4

Using Ignite AI to support students (teacher-facing)

[VERIFY] BEFORE USING

Ignite AI's exact feature names and availability vary by Canvas release and by what Optima has enabled on this instance. Everything below is described functionally — confirm the specific button or menu exists in your Canvas before promising it to yourself or a colleague.

Every use below is governed by two standing rules: **coach, not catch** (Section 8), and **AI drafts, the teacher decides** — the teacher always reads, edits, and owns anything before it reaches a student or family. Ignite AI is never used to surveil, rank, or auto-penalize a student.

1. Drafting individualized feedback

For the Studio Project rubric (Section 6), draft the row-by-row comments from a quick read of the artwork photo and Artist Statement, then edit for accuracy and voice before posting. This keeps ~5-minute-per-student grading honest while making written feedback feel personal.

2. Summarizing outro-survey analytics

Feed the outro survey's free-text and confidence responses into Ignite AI and ask for a one-paragraph summary of the cohort's sticking points before writing the next announcement. This turns the Section 2 triage habit into a fast first pass, not a blank page.

3. Surfacing students who need a nudge

Ask Ignite AI to flag students with a low outro confidence rating, a missed Skill Builder or Quiz, or a declining pattern, and draft a warm, specific check-in message for each. Read and personalize every draft before sending.

4. Generating practice variants

For a student who needs another rep on a Tier 1 skill (say, sighting for proportion after a rough Skill Builder 1 in Studio 1), ask Ignite AI to generate a short additional practice prompt in the same style, rather than reassigning the identical sketch.

5. Communicating with families

Use Ignite AI to draft clear, kind progress summaries or translate a message into a family's home language, then review before sending. Especially useful ahead of Studios 7, 13, and 14 — the sensitive-content scripts in Section 13 give you a starting point to adapt.

Per-Studio Ignite AI flag

Studio	Best single AI-assisted move
6	Summarize the Studio's source-check requirement (new Step 1b) into a one-line reminder before the Studio Project opens.
8	Draft feedback comments referencing growth across Studios 1–7, since the rubric explicitly asks about change over time.
11	Draft quick troubleshooting replies for students stuck on Canva/Pixlr E (the Studio's named required tools).
14	Draft the responsible-commentary feedback carefully — read every Artist Statement personally before using AI to help phrase feedback, given the social-commentary content.
16	Since every student researches a different artist, ask Ignite AI to summarize each proposal's sourcing before you check it against the approved source list.
17	Ask Ignite AI to pull up a one-line summary of each student's approved Studio 16 proposal so you have it on hand while grading Studio 17.
18	Use Ignite AI to draft end-of-year family summaries alongside the Final Exhibition grading — this is the last graded item of the course.

SECTION 5

Grading categories & Canvas gradebook setup

Grading categories (assignment groups)

Every Studio carries an identical graded-item mix: two Skill Builders (10 pts each), one Quiz, one VR Session or Art Critique (10 pts), and one Studio Project + Artist Statement (20 pts, the 5-row/4-pts-per-row rubric). Set the gradebook up as **weighted** assignment groups, not raw total points, so the weighting stays constant even though Studio 8's, 15's, and 18's items differ slightly in scope.

Assignment group	Maps to	Weight
Major Studio Projects & Artist Statements	Tier 3 — the Studio Project	60%
Skill Builders, VR & Quizzes (S1) Skill Builders, Critiques & Quizzes (S2)	Tier 1 — Skill Builder 1 & 2, VR Session (S1) or Art Critique (S2), Quiz	30%
Wrapper Surveys & Reflection	Tier 4 — Intro/Outro surveys	10%

Step-by-step Canvas setup

1. Course > Grades > gear icon > **Assignment Groups**. Create the three groups above.
2. Turn on "**Weight final grade based on assignment groups**" and enter 60 / 30 / 10.
3. Set the grading scheme to the standard Optima letter-grade scheme
[VERIFY current scheme name with the registrar].
4. Attach each Studio Project's rubric (Section 6) as a native Canvas Rubric so SpeedGrader scores it directly.
5. Mark both wrapper surveys as **ungraded survey** (or completion-only), never a points-based quiz.
6. Set Skill Builders and the VR Session / Art Critique to **Complete/Incomplete** grading — these are practice rungs, not the graded event.

7. The Quiz auto-grades on submission (Canvas Quiz, keyed answers). Confirm its point value in your build

[VERIFY — source files give item counts, not a stated point total]
8. Set a course-wide late/missing policy consistent with the school's standard policy.

Gradebook map — every graded item

Item	Assignment group	Points	Method
Skill Builder 1	Skill Builders, VR & Quizzes (S1) / Skill Builders, Critiques & Quizzes (S2)	10	Completion
Skill Builder 2	Skill Builders, VR & Quizzes (S1) / Skill Builders, Critiques & Quizzes (S2)	10	Completion
VR Session (S1) / Art Critique (S2)	Skill Builders, VR & Quizzes (S1) / Skill Builders, Critiques & Quizzes (S2)	10	Completion
Quiz (6–8 items, auto-graded)	Skill Builders, VR & Quizzes (S1) / Skill Builders, Critiques & Quizzes (S2)	[VERIFY]	Auto-graded (Canvas Quiz)
Studio Project + Artist Statement	Major Studio Projects & Artist Statements	20	Native Canvas Rubric
Intro survey	Wrapper Surveys & Reflection	— (survey/completion)	Survey / completion
Outro survey	Wrapper Surveys & Reflection	— (survey/completion)	Survey / completion

This row pattern repeats for all 18 Studios. Studio 8 swaps the two Skill Builders for two "Process Check-Ins" (text-entry, still Tier 1 completion); Studio 16's Studio Project is a Word .docx upload rather than an image upload — confirm the Canvas assignment allows .docx.

Studio-progress view

Use Canvas's **Module Requirements / student progress** view as your at-a-glance completion signal across the ungraded lesson scaffolding. It shows whether a student opened an item, not whether they engaged thoughtfully — pair it with the outro triage in Section 2 for the real signal.

SECTION 6

Rubrics for every teacher-graded item

FREE-RESPONSE QUIZ ANSWER GUIDES — NOT NEEDED

Every Studio's Quiz is built entirely from Canvas-native auto-gradable types — multiple choice, true/false, and matching. **Zero free-response, short-answer, or essay items exist in any Studio's Quiz.** The only teacher-scored item in the whole course is each Studio's Studio Project rubric, below.

The standard shape — 5 criteria, 20 points, 4 pts/row

Unlike a fully identical rubric reused across every Studio, this course writes three of the five rows to each Studio's specific content (since the Studios are decision-based, not media-repeats of one technique). Two rows are constant every time: **Artist Statement** and a **Completion & [Signature/Presentation/Format]** row. The table below gives every Studio's actual five criteria labels, read from each Studio's own rubric.

Studio	Row 1	Row 2	Row 3	Row 4	Row 5
1	Observation & Proportion	Value & Form	Technique / Craftsmanship	Artist Statement	Completion & Signature
2	Focal Point & Placement	Balance	Movement & Mood	Artist Statement	Completion & Signature
3	Mood & Color Expression	Color Theory Applied	Consistent Subject	Artist Statement	Completion & Craftsmanship
4	Linear Perspective	Depth Cues	Composition & Craftsmanship	Artist Statement	Completion & Signature
5	Pattern & Repetition	Print Technique / Craftsmanship	Positive & Negative Space	Artist Statement	Completion & Signature
6	Juxtaposition & Meaning	Composition & Unity	Texture & Layering	Artist Statement	Completion & Craftsmanship
7	Facial Proportion & Likeness	Symbolism & Meaning	Setting & Composition	Artist Statement	Craftsmanship & Completion

8	Genuine Revision	Curation & Selection	Sequencing	Reflective Artist Statement	Completion & Presentation
9	Observation Foundation	Abstraction Process / Progression	Craftsmanship	Artist Statement	Completion & Signature
10	Narrative Clarity	Sequencing & Composition	Technique / Craftsmanship	Artist Statement	Completion & Signature
11	Hierarchy & Layout	Typography	Message & Communication	Artist Statement	Completion & Signature
12	Elements & Principles	Non-Objective Craft	Artistic Voice & Intent	Artist Statement	Completion & Signature
13	Surrealist Concept	Observation & Rendering	Technique / Craftsmanship	Artist Statement	Completion & Signature
14	Message & Audience	Responsible Commentary	Technique / Craftsmanship	Artist Statement	Completion & Signature
15	Risk & Innovation	Media Combination & Craftsmanship	Process Documentation (Log)	Artist Statement	Completion & Signature
16	Research & Sourcing	Thesis & Artistic Voice	Media Plan & Sketches	Artist Statement	Completion & Format
17	Synthesis of Skills	Execution of the Proposal	Craftsmanship & Consistency	Artist Statement	Completion & Signature
18	Curation & Sequence	Wall Labels	Artist Statement	Presentation Quality	Completion

Every row uses the same 4-level scale (Excellent 4 / Proficient 3 / Developing 2 / Beginning 1), so grading stays at roughly 5 minutes per student even though the content-specific rows change every cycle. Paste each Studio's rubric into its Canvas assignment as a **native Canvas Rubric** so it scores directly in SpeedGrader.

Subject-specific rubrics beyond the standard shape

This course does not need a separate essay, research-paper, or performance-task rubric family: Studio 16's research proposal and Studio 18's exhibition both fold their own genre-specific criteria into the same 5-row, 20-point shape (see rows above), rather than requiring an entirely different rubric type.

SECTION 7

Quizzes & assessment activities — how to run & grade

NO DISCUSSION FORUMS IN THIS COURSE

The built cycle contains no Tier 2 discussion-forum item in any Studio. The per-cycle item set is exactly five things: two Skill Builders (Tier 1), one Quiz (Tier 1), one VR Session or Art Critique (Tier 1), one Studio Project + Artist Statement (Tier 3), bracketed by the Tier 4 intro/outro survey pair.

General guidance, by type

Type	What it is / how it's scored	Teacher move
Ungraded lesson widgets	Immediate self-feedback; no submission	Nothing to grade. If Skill Builder or Studio Project quality is weak, that's usually the signal a student rushed these — address it there.
Skill Builder 1 & 2	Completion, 10 pts each, Canvas file upload	Check for genuine effort and honest attempt at the technique; these are practice rungs, not a quality check.
Quiz	Auto-graded, 6–8 items, all MC/True-False/Matching	Nothing to grade by hand. Skim item analysis if Canvas offers it — a preview of the outro's "unclear" answers.
VR Session (Semester 1)	Completion, 10 pts, screenshot or written confirmation	Check evidence of the critique, reflect, and make steps; platform-agnostic, works the same solo or live.
Art Critique (Semester 2)	Completion, 10 pts, text entry or upload (Word document or voice recording)	Check that all four steps (Describe, Analyze, Interpret, Judge) are answered; VR is optional and does not change the submission.

Studio Project + Artist Statement	Teacher rubric, 20 pts, one submission	Score against the Section 6 rubric; lead comments with what's working, per Section 8.
Intro/Outro wrapper surveys	Ungraded/completion, Canvas Quiz survey mode	Don't grade content; triage the outro per Section 2.

Per-instance notes — where a Studio's Tier 3 item needs something specific

Studio	What to specifically check when grading this one
1	Standard rubric. No customization beyond the wording already in-file.
2–4	Standard rubric.
5	Standard rubric; allow real carving/inking/drying time — the Studio's project studio-time budget runs longer than one sitting.
6	Confirm the source-check step (new Step 1b) was actually done — students must verify any non-self-created photo/headline/image is public domain or fair-use-appropriate before cutting it into the collage.
7	If a student portrayed a consenting other person (not themselves), confirm that was teacher-approved in advance. Grade the symbolism and setting choices, not whether you personally find the sitter's chosen symbols meaningful.
8	This is 4–6 already-curated pieces plus a growth reflection, not a new artwork — grade the curation and revision quality, and expect a slightly longer per-student review than a single-piece Studio.
9–10	Standard rubric.
11	Confirm at least one thumbnail was built in Canva or Pixlr E — both are named, required tools for this Studio; hand-rendering is only acceptable if the winning thumbnail itself was hand-drawn.
12–13	Standard rubric.
14	Check the Artist Statement discloses any AI use (required; an undisclosed use scores Beginning-level). If the student did Step 2b's classmate pairing, confirm each partner still submitted and is graded individually.
15	This is a series of 3+ pieces plus a Risk Log, not one artwork — confirm at least one piece uses a dimensional or fiber-based technique (the Studio's added 4th "strong series" trait) and budget extra review time.
16	The deliverable is a Word .docx (research + sketches + proposal), not an image upload. Grading is necessarily more varied since every student researches a different artist —

grade the rubric rows as written, not the artist choice, and confirm sources come from the approved list (HS Art Sources.docx).

- | | |
|----|--|
| 17 | Keep the student's approved Studio 16 proposal open while grading — "Synthesis of Skills" and "Execution of the Proposal" both require comparing the finished piece back to that plan. |
| 18 | This is a curated set of 6–10 works plus wall labels and a full artist statement — budget the longest review time of the year. This is also the final teacher-graded item of the course; confirm it's wired as the terminal assessment in the gradebook. |

SECTION 8

Coach, not catch

The facilitator's job is to move each student forward, not to detect and punish. In practice, in this course:

- **Lead with what's working.** Rubric comments name the next concrete step (e.g. "push your darkest darks and protect the highlight"), not just where a criterion fell short.
- **Skill Builders are a practice tool.** Allow a re-attempt if a student clearly rushed or misread the technique — they exist to build the skill for the Studio Project, not to gatekeep it.
- **Use the outro triage and Ignite AI to find students early** (Sections 2 and 4), then reach out — never to build a case against a student.
- **On suspected AI misuse or academic dishonesty** in an Artist Statement: open a conversation first. This is especially relevant for Studio 14, where AI-disclosure is an explicit graded requirement — treat a missing disclosure as a formation moment, not an accusation, the first time it happens.
- **Public comments model good thinking** — if you share strong Artist Statements or artwork as examples, choose ones that model the thinking you want to spread; don't hold up weak work for public critique. On Studio 7 (Identity) and Studio 14 (Art & Society) especially, be careful never to single out a student's personal symbolism or chosen cause as an example without their consent.

SECTION 9

Weekly announcement scripts

SCOPING DECISION — STATED, NOT SILENT

This is an 18-Studio course. Rather than hand-write 18 full scripts, this section gives the reusable template, one fully drafted example per quarter (4 total), and a compact one-line "hook" for all 18 Studios a facilitator can drop into the template in under a minute.

Reusable template — clone for any Studio

TEMPLATE

Subject: Studio [N] is open — [Studio Title]

Hi Artists,

This week we're moving into Studio [N]: [Studio Title]. [One-line hook — see table below].

By [day], you should have read Lessons 1–2 and finished both Skill Builders. The one thing not to miss this cycle: [due date] — your Studio Project and Artist Statement.

[One warm, specific line of encouragement.]
— [Teacher name]

Drafted example — Quarter 1 (Studio 3, Color Speaks)

Subject: Studio 3 is open — Color Speaks

Hi Artists,

This week we're moving into Studio 3: Color Speaks. Van Gogh could paint the same sunflower a dozen ways and make it feel completely different each time — this cycle, you'll do the same with your own subject.

By Wednesday, you should have read Lessons 1–2 and finished both Skill Builders. The one thing not to miss: your three color versions and Artist Statement are due [due date] — keep your subject the same across all three so

the color choice does all the work.

Can't wait to see what mood you build with nothing but color.

— [Teacher name]

Drafted example — Quarter 2 (Studio 7, Identity)

Subject: Studio 7 is open — Identity

Hi Artists,

This week we're moving into Studio 7: Identity. A great portrait tells you who someone IS, not just what they look like — you'll choose the objects and setting that tell that story.

By Wednesday, you should have read Lessons 1–2 and finished both Skill Builders. The one thing not to miss: your Symbolic Self (or approved sitter) portrait and Artist Statement are due [due date] — name at least two symbols on purpose.

Take your time choosing what really represents you.

— [Teacher name]

Drafted example — Quarter 3 (Studio 11, Design for Communication)

Subject: Studio 11 is open — Design for Communication

Hi Artists,

This week we're moving into Studio 11: Design for Communication. A good poster grabs a viewer in two seconds flat — that's the whole game this cycle.

By Wednesday, you should have read Lessons 1–2 and finished both Skill Builders. The one thing not to miss: you'll need to build at least one thumbnail in Canva or Pixlr E before your poster is due [due date] — if you haven't used either tool, start early.

Looking forward to seeing your message land.

— [Teacher name]

Drafted example — Quarter 4 (Studio 18, Portfolio & Exhibition)

Subject: Studio 18 is open — Portfolio & Exhibition

Hi Artists,

This week we're moving into Studio 18, the final Studio of the year: Portfolio & Exhibition. It's time to curate the strongest 6–10 pieces from your whole year and present them like a real show.

By Wednesday, you should have read Lessons 1–2 and started choosing your works. The one thing not to miss: your Final Exhibition and full Artist Statement are due [due date] — this is the last graded item of the year.

I'm proud of the artist you've become this year — let's send it off well.

— [Teacher name]

Situational scripts

Situation	Script
Mid-Studio check-in	"If your confidence on last Studio's outro was low, this is your reminder that [office hours / a message to me] are open before this cycle's project is due. A quick question now saves a harder fix later."
Pre-major-assessment reminder	"Your Studio Project and Artist Statement are due [due date]. Re-read the rubric before you submit — the Artist Statement is worth as much as the artwork itself, so don't leave it for the last five minutes."
Re-engagement nudge (quiet students)	"Hi [student name], I noticed you haven't opened Studio [N] yet. No judgment — just checking in. Reply here or message me if something's in the way; I'd rather help now than have you fall behind."

One-line hooks — all 18 Studios

Studio	Title	Hook
1	Learning to See	The difference between glancing and truly looking, made visible on paper.
2	Organizing the Image	The same objects, arranged three ways, tell three different stories.
3	Color Speaks	One subject, three moods, using nothing but color.
4	Creating Space	Build a world you feel you could step into, on a flat sheet of paper.

5	Pattern, Print & Design	One carved block becomes rhythm, repeated again and again.
6	Layers of Meaning	Torn scraps of unrelated things, adding up to one meaning.
7	Identity	Paint who someone IS, not just how they look.
8	Mid-Year Portfolio Review	A curated argument about the artist you're becoming, not a pile of everything.
9	Transformation	Where does an observed thing end and an invented one begin?
10	Visual Storytelling	A whole story, told in pictures and no words.
11	Design for Communication	Make a message impossible to ignore.
12	Beyond Reality	Can a painting of nothing recognizable still be about something?
13	Dream Worlds	What truths can you only tell through a dream?
14	Art & Society	How does one image change what people believe or do?
15	Experimental Studio	What happens when you break your own rules on purpose?
16	Independent Investigation	What do YOU want to say, and who has said something like it before?
17	Capstone Studio	One work that shows everything you've become as an artist.
18	Portfolio & Exhibition	A year of work, presented so a stranger understands the artist you are.

SECTION 10

Teacher workflow & workload map

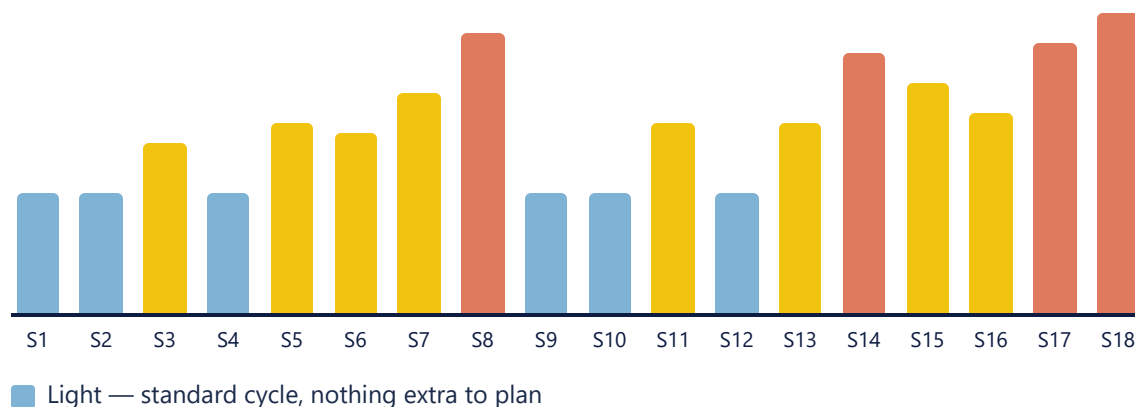
A normal week's teacher tasks, in order

1. Triage the outro survey from the Studio that just closed (15–20 min — Section 2).
2. Grade the cycle's Studio Project submissions in a batch against the standard rubric (~5–7 min/student — Section 6/7).
3. Post the weekly announcement (Section 9).
4. Answer student/family messages, using Ignite AI drafts where helpful (Section 4).
5. Spot-check Skill Builder/Quiz/VR Session/Art Critique completion via the progress view for anyone falling behind (Section 5).

Time budget per item, per the course-wide Optima standard: roughly 0 hours for Tier 1 (auto-graded/completion), 8–12 hours spread across the whole cohort for a Tier 3 item over its grading window, and no Tier 2 hours since this course has no discussion forum.

Where the extra time goes — heavier Studios

The raw count of graded touchpoints is flat across all 18 Studios (two Skill Builders, one Quiz, one VR Session or Art Critique, one Studio Project). What varies is facilitator prep and grading-scope time: materials/drying logistics, copyright link-out verification burden, sensitive-content family communication, and Studios where the graded item is a multi-piece body of work rather than one artwork.



■ Moderate — one specific prep/logistics item to handle

■ Heavy — multiple factors stack, or a multi-piece review

Heights reflect facilitator prep/grading-scope load, not graded-item counts (identical every Studio) or invented hour figures — see each tooltip for the specific reason.

SECTION 11

Standards coverage map

This course's benchmark set follows the same recurring VA.912 strand pattern every quarter, with the specific sub-strand rotating by quarter per the course's own standards tracker (_STUDIO-SPECS.md). Codes below are quoted as written in each Studio's teacher-cycle-plan; verify exact CPALMS wording before quoting to a family or auditor.

By standard — the quarterly rotation (FL NGSSS)

Quarter	Strands carried	Studios
Q1	C.1 (critique vocabulary) · C.2 (self-critique/statement) · S.1 (media exploration) · S.2 (studio-practice skill building) · O.1 (structural elements/principles) · H.1 (culture/time/place) · F.1 (innovation/technology)	1–4
Q2	C.1 · C.2 · S.1 · S.2 · O.2 (organizational principles: pattern, unity, proportion) · H.2 · F.2	5–8
Q3	C.1 · C.3 (portfolio/growth over time) · S.2 · S.3 (advanced technique/personal voice) · O.3 (advanced organizational structure) · H.3 · F.3	9–12
Q4	C.3 · S.3 · O.3 · H.3 · F.3	13–18

By Studio (quick reference)

Studio	FL NGSSS focus	TX TEKS Extension (19 TAC §117.302, Art Level I)
1	O.1 elements/principles · C.1 critique · C.2 self-critique · S.1/S.2 observation & skill · H.1 Renaissance/Photorealism · F.1 VR + AI	(c)(1)(A) direct observation · (c)(1)(B) elements in own work · (c)(4)(B) critique method
2	O.1 composition · C.1/C.2 critique & statement · S.1/S.2 arrangement skills · H.1 Hokusai/Hopper/Cartier-Bresson · F.1 VR + AI	(c)(1)(C) design principles (balance, movement) · (c)(2)(A) original artwork · (c)(4)(B) critique

3	O.1 color elements · C.1/C.2 · S.1/S.2 mixing/media · H.1 Van Gogh/Matisse/Rothko · F.1 VR + AI	(c)(1)(A) imagination/observation · (c)(1)(B) elements (color) · (c)(2)(F) media/tools · (c)(4)(B) critique
4	O.1 space/depth · C.1/C.2 · S.1/S.2 perspective media · H.1 Canaletto/Escher · F.1 VR + AI (machine-generated depth)	(c)(1)(B) elements (line, space) · (c)(2)(A) original artwork · (c)(4)(B) critique
5	O.2 pattern/rhythm · C.1 DAIJ-named · C.2 · S.1/S.2 print process · H.2 Hokusai/Warhol/Catlett · F.2 print-as-tech, VR, AI	(c)(1)(C) repetition/rhythm · (c)(2)(F) print media/tools · (c)(4)(B) critique
6	O.2 unity/texture · C.1/C.2 (Bearden) · S.1/S.2 mixed media · H.2 Dada/Bearden context · F.2 VR assemblage, AI	(c)(1)(B) texture/space · (c)(2)(F) collage/mixed-media tools · (c)(3)(B) cultural characteristics · (c)(4)(B) critique
7	O.2 proportion/composition · C.1 (Kahlo/Shepard/Wiley) · C.2 · S.1/S.2 facial proportion/symbolic rendering · H.2 identity/culture/historical moment · F.2 VR staging, AI [VERIFY — codes drawn from the course-wide Q2 set, not independently re-derived for this Studio]	(c)(1)(A) symbolic objects/setting · (c)(1)(B) facial-proportion elements · (c)(3)(B) cultural characteristics · (c)(4)(B) critique
8	C.2 self-critique across a body of work · C.3 portfolio/revision/growth · S.1 documentation · H.2 own body of work · F.2 digital tools/AI in presentation	(c)(4)(B) critique across a body of work · (c)(4)(C) build/evaluate a portfolio · (c)(1)(B) pattern-finding & revision
9	C.1 critique (O'Keeffe) · C.3 simplification/exaggeration/stylization · S.2 abstraction-ladder skill · S.3 critique informs revision · O.3 unified transformed compositions · H.3 O'Keeffe's career arc · F.3 Art Critique (VR optional) + AI	(c)(1)(A) concepts from observation/imagination · (c)(3)(A) compare historical/contemporary styles · (c)(4)(B) critique
10	O.3 sequence/structure · C.1 (Lawrence/Rockwell) · C.3 self-critique · S.2/S.3 storyboarding & synthesis · H.3 Great Migration/mid-century illustration · F.3 Art Critique (VR optional) + AI	(c)(2)(A) visual solutions via narration/imagination · (c)(3)(A) compare Lawrence vs. Rockwell · (c)(4)(B) critique
11	O.3 hierarchy/layout · C.1 design critique · C.3 self-critique (two-second test) · S.2/S.3 skill builders + advanced voice · H.3 Scher/Bass era · F.3 Art Critique (VR optional) + AI-generated layouts	(c)(1)(C) design principles · (c)(2)(F) Canva/Pixlr E tools · (c)(4)(B) critique

12	O.3 rhythm/balance · C.1 non-objective critique · C.3 personal voice/statement · S.2/S.3 skill + advanced synthesis · H.3 Kandinsky/Frankenthaler/Arcay · F.3 Art Critique (VR optional) + AI	(c)(1)(A) imagination/experience · (c)(1)(C) rhythm/balance/emphasis · (c)(3)(A) compare historical/contemporary · (c)(4)(B) critique
13	C.3 interpret/evaluate meaning (DAIJ-named) · S.3 technical skill on real+invented elements · O.3 organizational principles refine an idea · H.3 Surrealism's historical moment · F.3 careers/tech/AI	(c)(1)(A) imagination/experience · (c)(2)(A) visual solutions via imagination · (c)(3)(A) compare historical/contemporary (Surrealism) · (c)(4)(B) critique
14	C.3 art communicates on social/political issues · S.3 image-text composition · O.1 contrast/emphasis/hierarchy · H.3 artists respond to contemporary conditions · F.3 image manipulation/AI credibility	(c)(2)(A) argument-driven original artwork · (c)(3)(A) compare historical/contemporary propaganda · (c)(4)(B) critique
15	C.3 evaluate/refine via structured reflection · S.3 advanced self-directed practice · O.1 (carried) elements across combined media · H.3 innovation/departure from convention · F.3 innovation/risk/AI	(c)(1)(A) concepts from experience/imagination · (c)(2)(F) structured media combinations · (c)(4)(B)/(C) critique + portfolio log
16	C.3 critique own process/proposal · S.3 sustained inquiry/independent practice · O.3 personal point of view generates concept · H.3 research/cite context with verified sources · F.3 thoughtful, aware AI tool use	(c)(1)(A) sources/experience/imagination · (c)(4)(B) self-critique of proposal · (c)(4)(C) portfolio (the proposal itself)
17	C.1/C.2 critique + statement on own growth · C.3 evaluate artistic growth across a body of work · S.3 advanced self-directed technique · O.1 structural elements in original composition · F.1 innovation/process/AI	(c)(1)(A) synthesize year + Studio 16 research · (c)(2)(A) visual solutions (the Capstone build) · (c)(4)(B)/(C) critique + portfolio
18	C.3 evaluate own body of work & its presentation · S.3 accomplished self-directed application · O.3 cohesive final body of work · H.3 reflect on own development · F.3 career/lifelong-practice implications	(c)(4)(C) build/curate the Final Exhibition · (c)(4)(B) critique (Lesson 2 retrospective + Lesson 6 self-critique) · (c)(3)(A) compare how a retrospective sequences a career

FLAGGED FOR THE COURSE LEAD

Studio 7's FL NGSSS codes were reported in its teacher-cycle-plan as drawn from the course-wide Q2 benchmark set rather than independently re-verified against CPALMS for that specific Studio. Confirm before an external audit. Several link-out and PD-embed citations across Studios 2–18 carry a standing [\[VERIFY URL at deploy\]](#) or [\[VERIFY PD status at deploy\]](#) tag (notably Studio 9's O'Keeffe painting and Studio 12's Kandinsky painting, both claimed US-public-

domain by publication date) — these are pre-deploy verification tasks, not standards gaps, but should be closed before the course goes live to families.

Standard codes in this section are teacher-manual-only and should never be echoed to students.

SECTION 12

What makes this course classical & cultivating culture

What makes it classical

Classical move	Where it actually appears in this build
Wonder before mechanism	Every Studio's Lesson 1 opens with the Essential Question and a Look-First on the featured artwork before any technique vocabulary is introduced.
Primary-source encounter	Public-domain works are embedded from real archives with attribution; in-copyright and living-artist works link out to verified museum collection pages (the Met, MoMA, SFMOMA, the Art Institute of Chicago, the Harry Ransom Center, the Smithsonian) rather than a generic illustration.
A method taught, not named	The Describe/Analyze/Interpret/Judge critique sequence runs through every Studio's Lesson 2 and Lesson 6; the acronym itself is named only in the four quarter-opening Studios (1, 5, 9, 13), and never for a student's own-work critique anywhere in the course, per the July 2026 revision.
A real body of work, curated	Studio 8's mid-year portfolio and Studio 18's final exhibition make the whole year's formation visible to the student at once — not a folder of everything, but a curated argument about growth.
Research grounded in verified sources	Studio 16 requires students to research an artist of their choice using an approved source list (Smarthistory, the Met, Smithsonian Learning Lab, National Gallery of Art, MoMA, Tate, and similar), not an open web search.

Cultivating culture asynchronously

- **The Commonplace Corner.** The course's Canvas Home page carries a rotating "line worth keeping" — a quote from an artist connected to the current Studio (e.g. Leonardo's "the eye is the window of the soul" for Studio 1). Keep it genuinely rotating each cycle.
- **Substantive feedback as relationship.** With no discussion forum in this course, the rubric comment on the Studio Project + Artist Statement is the main

place a student hears a teacher's individual voice — treat it as a real response, not a checklist tick.

- **Name good thinking publicly, sparingly.** When sharing strong student work as an example (Section 8), say specifically what the student noticed or reasoned well.
- **Hold the virtue thread visible where it exists.** [VERIFY] — the sampled outro-survey descriptions confirm a growth reflection and a preview of the next Studio; whether a named seven-virtues reflection line is present in every outro (as in several sibling Optima courses) was not independently confirmed for this course and should be checked before claiming it in family communication.

Sensitive-content flags & family/student scripts

Studio 7 — Identity (self-portraiture / a real person's likeness)

What it is: The core Studio Project is a symbolic self-portrait, or — with teacher approval — a portrait of another willing sitter. Featured artists include Frida Kahlo (whose own symbolism draws on lifelong physical pain), and two living artists, Amy Sherald and Kehinde Wiley, whose work reframes historical portraiture conventions around race and representation.

SUGGESTED FAMILY/STUDENT SCRIPT (editable)

"Hi [families/students], next Studio we'll be studying portraiture that goes beyond likeness — how artists like Frida Kahlo, Amy Sherald, and Kehinde Wiley use objects, setting, and symbol to tell someone's story, not just show their face. Students will create a symbolic self-portrait (or, with my approval in advance, a portrait of another willing person) using personal symbols of their own choosing. If you have questions about this Studio, please reach out to me at [contact info] before we begin."

Studio 13 — Dream Worlds (surrealist / dream imagery)

What it is: The entire content focus is Surrealism — dislocation, impossible scale, metamorphosis, and dream logic, studied through Dalí, Magritte, and Varo (all in-copyright, all link-out, no embedded images).

SUGGESTED FAMILY/STUDENT SCRIPT (editable)

"Hi [families/students], next Studio we'll be studying Surrealism — how artists like Salvador Dalí, René Magritte, and Remedios Varo combined careful, realistic rendering with impossible, dreamlike situations. Students will create their own surreal artwork combining observation and imagination. This is a study of a major 20th-century art movement, not a request for disturbing content — students choose their own dream imagery. Reach out to me at [contact info] with any questions."

Studio 14 — Art & Society (social/political commentary)

What it is: Students choose a contemporary issue or cause important to them (school-appropriate) and make an artwork that argues for it, studying Barbara Kruger and Shepard Fairey (both living artists, both link-out). A historical WWI/WWII-era recruitment poster (James Montgomery Flagg's *I Want You*) appears strictly as a form example of image-text fusion, not an endorsement of its message.

SUGGESTED FAMILY/STUDENT SCRIPT (editable)

"Hi [families/students], next Studio students will be creating an artwork that makes an argument about a cause or issue that matters to them, studying how artists like Barbara Kruger and Shepard Fairey use image and text together to persuade. Students choose their own issue (school-appropriate) and must disclose any AI use in their Artist Statement. The goal is responsible, thoughtful visual communication, not partisan messaging. Reach out to me at [contact info] with any questions before we begin."

Studio 6 — Layers of Meaning (teacher-awareness note, not a family script)

Not flagged as sensitive — no family notice needed. Worth knowing: Studio 6's featured Dada artists (Höch, Schwitters) worked in the aftermath of World War I; the lesson handles this as historical/cultural context (per VA.912.H.2.x), not as graphic content. If a student asks why Dada art looks "chaotic on purpose," a ready answer is that it was a deliberate reaction to the perceived senselessness of the war.

Other content reviewed

Nothing else across the 18 Studios warranted a flag. Living and rights-managed artists in Studios 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 10, 11, 12 are handled purely as a copyright/media-literacy convention (Section 2), not a content-sensitivity issue.

Adapting the weekly cadence for a Live section meeting four days a week

A PLANNING TOOL, NOT A CONTENT CHANGE

Everything in this section is a facilitator day-by-day delivery plan for teachers running a synchronous Live section. The built Canvas assignments and lesson files are identical for On-Demand and Live students — nothing described here changes what gets built or graded. It only changes how a Live teacher paces the same five components across real class meetings.

Map the async 2-week (~250 min/week) Studio cycle onto 8 live class sessions (4 days a week, across 2 weeks):

Session	What happens in class
Week 1, Day 1	Students complete the Intro survey individually at the start of class. Teacher leads Lesson 1 (Observe): the Essential Question, the Look-First notice-and-wonder opening on the featured artwork, and the Big Idea.
Week 1, Day 2	Teacher delivers Lesson 2 (Investigate): the artist study and the Describe/Analyze/Interpret/Judge critique walkthrough (named "DAIJ" only in Studios 1, 5, 9, 13's Lesson 2; every other Studio calls it "the critique process").
Week 1, Day 3	Teacher demonstrates the Studio's first technique (Lesson 3); students complete Skill Builder 1 in class with the teacher circulating.
Week 1, Day 4	Teacher demonstrates the second technique (Lesson 4); students complete Skill Builder 2 in class. This is the natural day to flag any materials lead-time needs for the coming Studio Project (see the per-Studio table below).
Week 2, Day 5	Teacher walks through Lesson 5 (Plan & Create): planning the Studio Project, the factual AI-awareness point, and beginning the VR Session (Semester 1) or Art Critique (Semester 2) together, or scheduling individual VR time this week (optional for the Art Critique).
Week 2, Day 6	Students take the Quiz in class (same content as the at-home auto-graded version), then finish the VR Session or Art Critique. Studio work time on the Studio Project begins.

Week 2, Day 7	Studio work time continues, with the teacher circulating for in-process feedback and spoken critique conversations — a natural place to build in live self-assessment practice even in Studios where the async version doesn't prompt it as explicitly (e.g. Studios 2–4, 9–12).
Week 2, Day 8	Teacher delivers Lesson 6 (Refine, Reflect & Present): refinement strategies, self-critique, and Artist Statement writing in class. Students submit the Studio Project and complete the Outro survey as a group close, with time permitting for a short teacher-led share of 2–3 finished pieces.

Per-Studio weekly adaptation notes

Most Studios run the generic 8-day cadence above unchanged. The table below flags the eleven Studios where a Live facilitator should adjust something specific.

Studio	Weekly adaptation suggestion
1–4, 9, 10, 12	Standard 8-day cadence above, no adjustment needed.
5	Shift the studio-work start earlier: begin the relief-carving demonstration on Week 1, Day 4 (not Week 2, Day 6), since carving and inking need more real time than a single Day 6–7 block. Consider trading a Week 2 review moment for extra ink-drying time.
6	Add the source-check step (new Step 1b) explicitly to Week 1, Day 4's materials-gathering conversation, before students start cutting anything for the collage.
7	Send the Section 13 family script at least a few days before Week 1, Day 1. Use Week 1, Day 4 to confirm in writing which students (if any) plan to portray a consenting other person, so approval is on record before Week 2 studio time begins.
8	This Studio has no Skill Builders 1/2 — it replaces them with two Process Check-Ins (planning/self-critique, then sequencing/capture-plan), so Week 1, Days 3–4 become in-class portfolio-review workshops rather than technique demonstrations. Budget more of Week 2 for individual conferencing, since the deliverable is a curated set, not one new piece.
11	Book a computer lab or device day for Week 1, Day 4 and Week 2, Day 6–7 so students can build their required Canva or Pixlr E thumbnail in class rather than at home.
13	Send the Section 13 family script before Week 1, Day 1.
14	Send the Section 13 family script before Week 1, Day 1. Use Week 1, Day 4 to pair students by related cause for the required Step 2b conversation, so pairs are set before Week 2 studio time. Remind students on Week 2, Day 8 that AI use must be disclosed in the Artist Statement.
15	This Studio produces a series (3+ pieces) plus a Risk Log, not one artwork — extend Week 2 studio time across Days 6–8 rather than compressing to Day 8, and use Day 8 partly for log write-up instead of only the Artist Statement.

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|----|--|
| 16 | Book library/research time for Week 1, Days 3–4 so students can work from the approved source list (HS Art Sources.docx) in class. The Week 2 deliverable is a Word .docx proposal, not an image — Day 8 should be a writing workshop, not a studio session. |
| 17 | Before Week 1, Day 1, confirm every student's Studio 16 proposal is approved; hold any student without one back from starting new work. Keep each student's proposal available during Week 2 studio-time conferencing. |
| 18 | Treat Week 2, Day 8 as a real event, not just a submission day — this is the last graded item of the year and a natural moment for a small in-class or virtual exhibition share. |
-

Live-section pacing calendar, all 18 Studios

HOW TO READ THIS CALENDAR

This calendar maps all 18 Studios onto the board-approved 2026–2027 school-year calendar (the same calendar used in the course syllabus), assuming a Live section meeting 4 days a week. Dates are a **planning guide**, not a guarantee — a facilitator should align the exact days to their own published class calendar, especially around the holidays and breaks noted below. On-Demand students are unaffected by any of this; they pace to their own enrolled term regardless of what a Live section is doing in a given week.

Studio	Title	Quarter	Approximate live-class window (2026–27)	Calendar note
1	Learning to See	Q1	Aug 12 – Aug 25	First Studio of the year.
2	Organizing the Image	Q1	Aug 26 – Sep 8	Labor Day (Sep 7) falls in this cycle — one fewer live day.
3	Color Speaks	Q1	Sep 9 – Sep 22	—
4	Creating Space	Q1	Sep 23 – Oct 6	A short buffer (Oct 7–9) follows before Quarter 1 closes Oct 9.
5	Pattern, Print & Design	Q2	Oct 12 – Oct 25	Columbus Day (Oct 12) opens this cycle — one fewer live day. Opens Q2.
6	Layers of Meaning	Q2	Oct 26 – Nov 8	—
7	Identity	Q2	Nov 9 – Nov 22	Veterans' Day (Nov 11) falls in this cycle — one fewer live day. Send the Section 13 family script before this cycle opens.
8	Mid-Year Portfolio Review	Q2	Nov 30 – Dec 13	Thanksgiving break (Nov 23–27) falls in the gap before this cycle — a natural pause before the mid-year review. A short buffer (Dec 14–18)

follows before the semester ends Dec 18.

9	Transformation	Q3	Jan 5 – Jan 18	Opens the spring semester. MLK Day (Jan 18) falls at the end of this cycle.
10	Visual Storytelling	Q3	Jan 19 – Feb 1	—
11	Design for Communication	Q3	Feb 2 – Feb 15	Presidents' Day (Feb 15) falls at the end of this cycle. Book the computer lab for this window.
12	Beyond Reality	Q3	Feb 16 – Mar 1	A short buffer (Mar 2–5) follows before Quarter 3 closes Mar 5.
13	Dream Worlds	Q4	Mar 8 – Mar 21	Opens Q4. Send the Section 13 family script before this cycle opens.
14	Art & Society	Q4	Apr 6 – Apr 15	Spring break (Mar 26–Apr 5) falls between Studio 13 and Studio 14 — a clean pause point; do not try to split this Studio across the break. Send the Section 13 family script before this cycle opens.
15	Experimental Studio	Q4	Apr 16 – Apr 27	—
16	Independent Investigation	Q4	Apr 28 – May 7	Book library/research time.
17	Capstone Studio	Q4	May 10 – May 19	Confirm every student's Studio 16 proposal is approved before this cycle opens.
18	Portfolio & Exhibition	Q4	May 20 – May 28	Final Studio of the year, ending on the last day of school (May 28). Plan a small exhibition share.

A REAL CALENDAR CONSTRAINT — PLAN AHEAD FOR Q4

As designed, Quarter 4 carries six two-week Studios (13–18) — nominally 12 live weeks. The 2026–2027 calendar's actual Q4 window (Mar 8 – May 28, minus the Mar 26–Apr 5 spring break) provides closer to 10 real weeks. This is a genuine scheduling tightness in the calendar, not a flaw in the course content, and it is the same compression already reflected in the course's own Course Map (Q1–Q3 each carry 4 Studios; Q4 carries 6). A Live facilitator should expect Q4 Studios to run slightly leaner than a full 8-session cycle — closer to 6–7 live sessions each — and should plan Studio 14 and Studio 17 (the two Studios with

the most facilitator logistics, per Section 10) first for any trimming decisions, since they carry the most that can be moved partly to independent work time.

Optima Academy Online · 2D Studio Art 2 (0101310) · Teacher Manual

Facilitator copy. Contains answer keys and grading guidance. Do not publish to students.